

Minimundo – Aubagne

Answers to your questions of 29 August 2026. Your questions are in blue, our answers in black.

One point before the seven questions. Aubagne is the first Minimundo, not a one-off. Our intention is to open this concept in many other cities around the world — and we are already working together on a first project in Australia. What we design here is therefore a model we will want to reproduce, so we are looking for a strong and coherent identity and a very high level of quality from the very beginning. To be clear on one point: catalogue products are absolutely fine with us as long as the quality is there. Being able to pick and choose from what you already produce well is an advantage, not a compromise. If this works, you are not quoting one park but the first of a series, and we are happy to discuss early what that means for both of us.

1. Opening target and reverse schedule

As the target opening is December 2026, the available time for manufacturing, transportation, site preparation, installation, commissioning and final approval is very limited. We would like to discuss the key dates for: final layout approval; quotation and contract confirmation; production start; site readiness and handover for installation; installation window and final inspection before opening.

Our target is to open on **Wednesday 16 December 2026**, three days before the French Christmas school holidays start on 19 December.

Working backwards from that date — 6 to 7 weeks of sea freight to Fos-sur-Mer including customs and inland delivery, 3 weeks of installation, 10 days of statutory inspections — gives the following schedule:

- **18 September** – final layout approval, quotation confirmed, contract signed, deposit paid
- **21 September** – production starts; factory slot and freight booking confirmed; visa applications launched the same week
- **2 October** – document file sent to us (test reports, material certificates, manuals)
- **10 October** – first container leaves the factory; further containers staged, the last one by 30 October
- **15 October** – go / no-go checkpoint. If the first container has not shipped, we postpone the opening to 20 February 2027
- **13 November** – site ready and handed over to you: finished and dry floor, electrical supply points per zone, general lighting installed, HVAC running, sprinklers and fire systems installed and tested, truck access, storage room, access equipment
- **18 November to 4 December** – installation
- **7 to 11 December** – snagging, initial electrical and playground inspections by an approved body, safety commission visit and opening authorisation
- **16 December** – opening

The layout freeze on 18 September is the date that drives everything else. After that date, any change costs time rather than money.

What we need from you on this point: your real production lead time for this volume; whether you can reserve a factory slot now against a letter of intent; a firm commitment on the first shipping date; staged shipments loaded in installation order with a packing list per container; and a quotation for China–Europe rail or partial air freight as a contingency.

2. Site conditions, facilities rooms and common areas

We understand that the reception, bar, birthday rooms, changing area, restrooms, shop and storage locations are fixed. To design the overall visitor flow correctly, we would like to understand: your planned operating model and customer journey; how the reception, bar, shop and birthday rooms will be used in daily operation; whether any of these fixed areas require our design, furniture, visual treatment or equipment scope.

Operating model. Our core target is **families with children from 1 to 10 years old**. Two-hour timed sessions at peak times (Wednesday, weekends, school holidays) with 3 to 4 rotations per day, free flow off-peak. Three revenue streams: family admissions, birthday parties, and groups — schools, holiday centres, company events and private evening hire.

Customer journey. Entrance and queuing area, then reception and ticketing, then cloakroom with lockers and non-slip socks. A short transition leads to the central square, where the whole city should be visible at once. Children then roam freely through the streets, with scheduled animations at fixed times to give the city its rhythm. The parents' bar overlooks the square and the action zone. Given the layout of the building, visitors will cross the play hall to reach the birthday rooms — that is acceptable to us. Visitors exit through the shop, and restrooms and baby-changing are reachable from the city without going back through reception.

Scope on these areas. To answer your question directly: **yes, we would like all of them in your scope** — reception, bar, shop, birthday rooms, cloakroom and lockers, restroom decoration, wayfinding signage and the storage areas. We want a single design hand and one visual world across the whole venue, not a themed city surrounded by ordinary commercial furniture. Please include design, furniture, visual treatment and equipment for these spaces.

The final connections — water, waste, electrical supply and ventilation — will be carried out by our French companies, so please give us your technical drawings and your supply point requirements early.

Please price each of these areas on its own line, exactly as for the themed spaces, so that we can arbitrate space by space without renegotiating the whole package.

One constraint for your layout: sightlines. From the bar and from a single supervision point, staff must be able to see the square, the entrance to the action zone and the slide exits.

3. Height restrictions, HVAC and emergency exits

We would like to clarify the following site constraints before starting the layout: final positions of HVAC, sprinklers, lighting, smoke detectors and other MEP services — will these be subject to our design? Required safety-clearance distances around each emergency exit and the applicable local requirements.

HVAC, sprinklers, fire detection, smoke extraction and emergency lighting are designed and installed by our French architect and engineering office, under the supervision of our control office. **They are not within your scope and their positions cannot be moved.** You design within them.

We will provide: DWG drawings of the existing building, the MEP layout with dimensions, clear heights under beams and under sprinkler heads, exit positions and escape routes, and slab constraints. Within 7 days of layout V1 we need from you: 3D envelopes in a format our engineers can use, finished heights, distributed and point loads, anchoring positions and forces, and electrical demand per zone with connection points.

The design rules to respect:

- Minimum 0.50 m left clear below all sprinkler heads.

- **Any raised level, platform or roof must let sprinkler water through** — nets or open grids rather than solid surfaces. If we apply this rule everywhere from the start, we will never be blocked on this subject, either by the control office or by our insurer.
- Nothing may obstruct emergency lighting, smoke detectors, alarm sounders, extinguishers or smoke vent controls. No suspended element without prior approval.
- Escape routes keep their full width along the whole path, and the area in front of every emergency exit stays entirely clear over at least 1 m and the full width of the door. No dead end that cannot be supervised.
- The exact clearance and travel distances depend on our final ERP classification and occupancy figure. Our control office will issue them as firm constraints before the layout freeze.
- Accessibility: continuous circulation, turning areas, thresholds and counter heights according to the dimensions we will send you.

On height: the 5 m is a gross figure. After sprinkler clearance we expect **4.20 to 4.50 m genuinely usable** — please design on that figure and confirm it with us before the freeze. We are not planning a full ceiling treatment, but we would like to use the volume visually: decoration and signage placed high up to give a real feeling of height when you enter.

On noise: we are not asking for a dedicated acoustic treatment, but we would like the materials to be chosen so that the noise level stays moderate for the parents.

4. Miniature-city design direction

We understand that the project should feel like a real, connected miniature city rather than a row of separate modules. We would like to align on: the priority themed spaces and any themes you would prefer to include or exclude; the required balance between role-play, interactive games, integrated physical/soft play and free exploration; your expectations for façade detail, props, interactive elements, lighting, backlit signage and decorative street details; the desired level of material quality, durability and maintenance requirements.

The principle. We want a city plan, not a list of modules: a central square that acts as the heart, the viewpoint and the meeting point; two or three streets radiating from it; terraced façades with an apparent upper floor and lit windows; pavements and pedestrian crossings marked on the floor; street furniture — lamp posts, benches, letterbox, traffic light, kiosk, trees; backlit street signs and house numbers; decoration in the upper part of the volume to give a sense of height; ambient sound per district. Circulation forms a continuous loop: children move through the city, they do not queue in front of stands. Each trade has a shopfront on the street and an interior.

Priority spaces. Supermarket or market — the most played space everywhere, please oversize it. Fire station with truck. Veterinary clinic. Kitchen, bakery and pizzeria. Construction site, linked to the action zone. Garage, service station and vehicle circuit. TV studio and stage. Hair and beauty salon. Post office and bank. Creative workshop and school as the quiet space. Farm, garden and recycling. Station or airport. Plus a **separate area for the youngest children**, visible from the bar.

Balance of floor area: role-play 45 to 50 %, action and physical play 20 to 25 %, interactive and digital 10 %, free exploration, toddlers and circulation 20 %.

Level of detail. High. The façades, props, backlit signage, lighting and street details are exactly what turns themed spaces into a city — this is where we want the effort to go.

Quality. This is the point where we want to be demanding, and we would rather rely on your best standard than dictate a specification: commercial grade, built for intensive daily use, and still looking good after

several years. Catalogue products are welcome wherever they meet that level. Please bring physical material samples, and photographs of installations that are a few years old rather than photographs taken at the factory.

One expectation that follows from Aubagne being the first site: we want the design to be **documented and reproducible** — drawings, material and colour references and print files organised so that the identity can be rebuilt or adapted city by city rather than reinvented each time.

5. Action zone and capacity

For the action zone, including illuminated slides, construction/excavation play, ball-pit activities and a ninja course, we would like to confirm: target age groups; expected peak capacity; whether you prefer one concentrated action zone or several distributed elements, because the height (5 m) will be the main effect for the action zone; any priority equipment or experience that must be included.

Age groups. Our core target is families with children from 1 to 10 years old. Rather than impose a breakdown, we would like to see what you propose in terms of age zoning, with a distinct and protected area for the youngest.

Capacity. We are sizing the venue for a peak of **250 to 300 children**. The action zone should absorb 25 to 30 % of the children present at peak, so around 75 to 90 simultaneous users, supervised by two staff from a single point with full visibility. Please confirm the capacity and the hourly throughput of each element.

One concentrated zone. We prefer a single, concentrated action zone rather than elements spread around the venue — it is easier to supervise and it gives the space a clear centre of energy. This is also where the available height should be used.

Priority equipment: an LED tube slide from the top level and a wide racing slide with 2 or 3 lanes; a **ninja course including an obstacle that pushes children off the wall** — without any timer or scoring, we want play rather than competition; the construction and excavation zone with excavators and a crane; a ball pit arena with cannons, with a practical solution for cleaning and recovering the balls; and low-height climbing.

6. French compliance and documentation

To prepare the correct technical and commercial proposal, we would like to clarify: the respective responsibilities of your architect, local consultants and the supplier for French ERP, PV, fire safety, accessibility and final approval; which EN, CE and test reports are required from your side; which certificates or documents must be issued locally in France; material, flooring, cleaning and maintenance requirements for daily operation.

How we see the split. The French ERP file is ours: classification and occupancy calculation, the works authorisation and safety notice, fire safety systems, smoke extraction, emergency lighting, accessibility, the initial electrical and playground inspections by an approved body, the safety commission visit and the mayor's opening authorisation, the safety register, the maintenance plan, staff training and operator insurance. These are handled by our architect, our engineering office, our control office and the local authority. You do not have to carry that file, and we are not asking you to become experts in French regulation.

What we need from you is the product documentation that allows our control office and the safety commission to sign off. This is the one area where we cannot be flexible about the result, because the opening authorisation depends on it — but we are completely open about the route to get there, and we would much rather build the list together now than discover a gap in December.

So the first thing we would like to hear from you is simply: **what do you normally provide to your European customers?** Which laboratory, which standards, and could you send us one or two sample reports? Our control office will tell us within a few days whether they can be used as they stand, and where something needs to be completed locally. That check costs nothing in September; the same check in November would be a serious problem for both of us.

Our starting list, to be discussed together:

- Test reports against EN 1176-1 to -11 and EN 1177 from a recognised third-party laboratory — ideally referenced to our own equipment, with free fall heights and safety zones shown on drawings.
- Fire reaction classification for the materials that matter most: foams, PVC and leatherette coverings, nets, floor coverings, decorative panels and suspended elements. In France this is read through EN 13501-1. If your usual reports follow a different route, send them to us and we will have them checked; where something is missing, a material can also be tested in France, provided we know early enough.
- CE declarations for electrical products and for any machinery such as motorised vehicles or excavators.
- The usual compliance statements for the materials children touch: EN 71-3, REACH, and the formaldehyde class of the panels.
- A structural calculation and anchoring plan for the main structures and for any suspended element.
- A handover file: as-built drawings, electrical schematics, operating and maintenance manuals, a spare parts list, the print files for the decoration, and cleaning instructions per material.
- Your product liability insurance certificate.

On language: French manuals would help us, and we will ask you whether that is possible — but if it is difficult, English is fine and we will have the documents translated locally. Our only real request on timing is that the document file be complete before the goods ship, so that nothing has to be chased during installation.

Issued locally in France, by us: the works authorisation and safety notice, the initial electrical and playground verification reports, the accessibility attestation, the safety commission report and the opening order, and the safety register.

Daily operation. What matters most to us is that the surfaces are easy to clean and that we receive a clear maintenance plan with the inspection frequencies, so we can register it and train our staff on it.

Installation. We want **your own installers on site in France, leading the installation.** This matters to us: nobody knows your products better, and the first Minimundo has to be assembled exactly as you intended it. We will provide a local team to work alongside them for handling, unpacking, logistics and general labour, along with site facilities, access equipment, storage and waste removal.

Everything that belongs to the building stays with our French companies: sprinklers and fire systems, plumbing, and the main electrical installation up to the supply points in each zone. Your team connects the equipment from there, with a French electrician alongside for the final connection and the certification.

On the practical side, if your technicians travel to France, Schengen visas take 4 to 8 weeks and should be launched as soon as we sign, and posted-worker formalities apply: SIPS declaration, a representative in France, social coverage and the applicable minimum wage. Please tell us how you usually handle this for European projects and we will prepare it with you. In the quotation, please state how many of your own people you plan to send and for how many days.

7. Quotation scope

Finally, we would like to confirm the required quotation format: separate pricing by themed space; manufacturing, delivery to Aubagne, on-site installation and optional items; payment terms, warranty expectations, spare parts and after-sales support.

Format. Please issue the quotation as an Excel file, or any other easily readable format, with **one line per item**: reference, themed space, description, photo, dimensions, materials, quantity, unit price, total, weight, volume, production lead time, target age and capacity. A summary total alone will not let us arbitrate or adjust the scope.

- **A. Design fees** – 2D, 3D and technical drawings. State whether they are deducted from the order. Ownership of the drawings transfers to us.
- **B. Manufacturing** – priced **separately for each themed space and for each facility area** (reception, bar, shop, birthday rooms, cloakroom, restrooms, storage, signage). This line-by-line breakdown is essential for us.
- **C. Packing** – marked by zone and by installation sequence, with a packing list per container, so that we unload in the right order.
- **D. Freight** – please quote both FOB and DAP Aubagne unloaded, and tell us which you would recommend: you can organise the shipping, or we can handle it with our own forwarder, as we are 30 km from the port of Marseille. Customs duties and import VAT identified separately.
- **E. Installation** – the number of your own technicians and the number of days on site, plus what is included: tools, consumables, flights, accommodation, visas and per diem. Our local support team, site facilities, access equipment, storage and waste removal are on us.
- **F. Options** – each on its own line: anything you would suggest as an addition, or for a later phase.
- **G. Spare parts** – a spare parts kit delivered with the park, with the list and the prices.

Payment terms. Please tell us what you propose, and we will discuss it from there.

Warranty and after-sales. Likewise, please tell us what you offer: warranty duration on the structures, the decoration, the soft parts and the electronics, how long spare parts remain available, and how you handle after-sales support for a site in Europe.

Repeat orders. Since Aubagne is intended to be the first of several sites, please also tell us how long your prices remain valid and what conditions you could offer on repeat orders of the same equipment.